

Deficiency-Heat Clearing Herbs

- These herbs enter the yin aspect.
- Underlying yin deficiency with superficial manifestations of heat.
- These herbs are also useful in the later stages of warm pathogenic diseases, where the pathogenic heat is not yet fully expended but the yin fluids have already been injured.
- Sweet and cold; Enter the Kidney and Liver.

Qīng Hāo 青蒿

“bluegreen artemisia”

- *Herba Artemisiae Annuae*
- **English:** sweet wormwood herb, sweet annie
- **Properties:** acrid, bitter, **cold**
- **Channels:** Kidney, Liver, Gallbladder
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Actions and Indications

Actions: Checks malarial disorders and relieves heat:

Indications: for alternating fever and chills due to malaria disorders. Higher dosage. Can use fresh Qing Hao to make juice.

Actions: Clears heat and cools blood

Indications: late-stage febrile disorders where the heat factor has entered the ying level, or consistent low-grade fever.

Sheng Di Huang, Mu Dan Pi, Bie Jia

Actions: Clears deficiency-heat:

Indications: for yin deficiency heat, including low-grade fever, night sweats, five-center heat, thirst, and irritability.

Zhi Mu, Huang Bai, Mu Dan Pi

Actions: Clears summerheat:

Indications – especially for summer heat with low-grade fever, headache, dizziness, and a stifling sensation in the chest.

Lu Dou, He Ye,

Main Actions:

Checks malaria and clears heat

Clears yin-deficient heat, cools blood

Clears summer-heat

Dosage: 3-10 grams

Notes:

Juice it from fresh Qing Hao

Only cooked for a short period of time.

• **Review Questions**

- What are the channels and properties of Qing Hao?
- What are the actions and indications of Qing Hao?
- What herbs clear summer heat?
- What herbs treat malaria?
- What is the special preparation for Qing Hao?

Bái Wēi 白 薇

“white rose”

- *Radix Cynanchi Atrati*
- **English:** swallowwort root
- **Properties:** bitter, salty, cold
- **Channels:** Lung, Stomach, Kidney
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Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, cools the blood, and promotes urination:

Indications: for hot or bloody painful urinary dysfunction, especially before or after childbirth. *Sheng Di Huang, Dan Zhu Ye*

Actions: Clears heat (excess & deficient) and cools blood:

Indications: Heat due to EPI, Heat entering Ying, Cough due to Lu Heat, Yin-deficient heat Postpartum fever/ Lingering fever as the sequelae of a warm-febrile disease that injures the blood or yin.

- Heat enters Ying: *Sheng Di Huang, Mu Dan Pi*
- Wind-heat with yin xu: *Bo He, Dan Dou Chi*
- Cough due to Lu heat: *Zhe Bei Mu, Qian Hu*
- Yin-deficient heat: *Di Gu Pi, Zhi Mu, Huang Bai*
- Postpartum fever due to blood xu and heat: *Dang Gui, Ren Shen, Gan Cao*

Lingering fever as the sequelae of a warm-febrile disease that injures the blood or yin:

Sheng Di Huang, Mai Men Dong, Di Gu Pi

Actions: Eliminates heat and toxins and treats sores

Indications: for toxic sores, swollen and painful throat, or snakebite

Main Actions:

Clears heat, cools the blood
Promotes urination, unblocks Lin syndrome.
Eliminates heat and toxins and treats sores.

• **Review Questions**

- What are the channels and properties of Bai Wei?
- What are the actions and indications of Bai Wei?
- What herbs clear excess and deficient heat?

Dì Gǔ Pí 地骨皮

“ground bone skin”

- *Cortex Lycii Radicis*
- **English:** cortex of wolfberry root, lycium bark
- **Properties:** sweet, bland, **cold**
- **Channels:** Lung, Liver, Kidney

Actions and Indications

Actions: Drains fire from yin deficiency and relieves steaming bones sensation:

Indications: for such symptoms as night sweats, steaming bone disorder with sweating, chronic low-grade fever, irritability, and thirst. *Zhi Mu, Bie Jia*

Actions: Clears heat and stops cough:

Indications: for Lung heat, cough, or wheezing.

Sang Bai Pi, Gan Cao

Actions: Clears heat and cools the blood:

Indications: for nosebleed, vomiting blood, and bloody urine due to the reckless movement of hot blood.

Bai Mao Gen, Ce Bai Ye

Actions: Drains floating fire in the Kidney channel

Indications: for toothache due to deficiency-fire; also used to treat Xiao Ke syndrome.

Cools the blood, clears and drains Lung heat, and relieves steaming-bone sensation.

Dosage: 6-12 grams.

Cautions: diarrhea due to Spleen Xu.

• **Review Questions**

- What are the channels and properties of Di Gu Pi?

- What are the actions and indications of Di Gu Pi? - What herb clears Lung Heat and deficient heat?
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None NCCAOM Herbs

Yín Chái Hú 银柴胡

“silver barbarian kindling”

- *Radix Stellariae Dichotomae*
- **English:** Stellaria root
- **Properties:** sweet, cool
- **Channels:** Liver, Stomach
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Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears yin-deficiency heat

Indications: for yin-deficiency fire with steaming bone disorder or any yin-deficient fever.

Actions: Clears heat and reduces childhood nutritional impairment:

Indications: for fever, thirst, and irritability associated with childhood nutritional impairment due to the accumulation of heat

Main Actions:

Clears yin-deficiency heat

Reduces childhood nutritional impairment

Dosage: 3-10 grams

- Use with caution in patients with exterior wind-cold or blood deficiency without heat.

Hú Huáng Lián 胡黄连

“barbarian yellow connection”

- *Rhizoma Picrorhizae*
- **English:** Picrorhiza rhizome
- **Properties:** bitter, cold
- **Channels:** Liver, Stomach, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears deficiency-heat:

Indications: for yin-deficiency with heat signs

Actions: Clears heat and reduces childhood nutritional impairment:

Indications: most appropriate when this disorder is accompanied by abdominal distention, afternoon fever, and dysenteric diarrhea

Actions: Drains damp-heat and eliminates toxins

Indications: damp-heat in the Stomach and Intestines leading to dysenteric disorder (similar to *Huang Lian*) or hemorrhoids (with goose bile).

Main Actions:

Clears deficiency heat

Clears heat and reduces childhood nutritional impairment

Drains damp-heat and eliminates toxins

- **Dosage:** 3-10 grams

• Review Questions

- What are the common actions and indications for these herbs?
- What herbs treat childhood “Gan Ji”?
- Review other herbs that also clear deficient heat from previous section(s).